Will the City Take It?

A Rockford homeowner's guide to getting rid of almost anything — furniture, mattresses, appliances, TVs, tires, paint, and debris. Free from FirstStep Junk Removal.

1 THE QUICK ANSWER

ITEM	CITY PICKUP?	WHAT TO DO
Furniture — couch, chairs, tables, dressers	**YES — bulk**	Set out on your regular garbage day. Charged at the city's bulk refuse rate — call Rock River Disposal (815-965-2489) to confirm the amount.
Mattress / box spring	**YES — bulk**	King sets: cut the box spring in half, fold the mattress in half and secure with tape or rope. Wrap anything infested in plastic.
Fridge, freezer, air conditioner	**YES — with proof**	Only with a licensed refrigeration technician's certification that it is refrigerant-free.
Washer, dryer, stove, dishwasher	**YES — bulk**	Set out on garbage day at the bulk rate.
Toilet	**YES — prepped**	Separate the tank from the bowl before setting out.
Boards, poles, long lumber	**YES — prepped**	Cut into pieces no longer than 4 feet.
Household trash bags	**YES**	Under 50 lbs each, in 13–40 gallon containers or bags, out by 6:00 AM.
TVs, monitors, electronics	**NO — never at the curb**	Banned from Illinois landfills. Take to a Keep Northern Illinois Beautiful center (fee for TVs) or ShredTronics — see page 2.
Paint, oil, chemicals, pesticides	**NO**	Free drop-off at the Household Hazardous Waste Center, 3315 Kishwaukee St — Sat 8–4, Sun 12–4. Latex paint goes to a PaintCare site instead.
Tires	**NO at the curb**	City residents: up to 4 passenger tires free per vehicle per day at 3315 Kishwaukee St. You load them into the container.
Construction debris, roofing, concrete	**NO**	Haul it to a landfill yourself (page 2) or hire it out.
Yard waste, branches, leaves	**Seasonal**	City yard-waste pickup runs seasonally — check the city schedule. Or Rock River Valley Composting (page 2).

Rockford contracts residential collection to Rock River Disposal. Bulk items go out on your regular garbage day — no appointment. If an item is unusually large, call Rock River Disposal first (815-965-2489) to confirm they can take it.

2 BEFORE YOU PUT IT OUT

So it actually gets picked up

- Everything out by **6:00 AM** on collection day.
- No bag, can, or bundle over **50 pounds**.
- King mattress sets: halve the box spring, fold & secure the mattress.
- Refrigerant appliances: certification in hand, or it stays.
- Very large items: call **815-965-2489** first.

Never at the curb

- TVs, monitors, computers — landfill-banned in Illinois.
- Paint (oil-based), solvents, oil, fuel, pesticides.
- Propane / helium tanks, explosives, ammunition.
- Car batteries — return to an auto store or KNIB center.
- Medications — use a pharmacy take-back, not the trash.

Cleaning out a whole room, garage, or house? The city takes one bulk item at a time, on its schedule, with its prep rules. If you want it all gone today — no cutting, no wrapping, no waiting — that's exactly what we do. See page 2.

Drop It Off Yourself

Every Rockford-area drop-off worth knowing, with addresses, hours, and gate rates. Fees change — call ahead before you load up.

3 FREE & SPECIALTY DROP-OFFS

Household Hazardous Waste Center

3315 Kishwaukee St, Rockford · 779-348-7425

Sat 8 AM–4 PM · Sun 12–4 PM · FREE for Illinois residents (no businesses). Closed New Year's Day, Easter, July 4th, Christmas.

Aerosols, corrosives, solvents, oil-based paint, waste oil, fuel, pesticides, fertilizer, household batteries, fluorescent lamps. Liquids in secure containers, 5 gallons max. Up to 4 passenger tires per vehicle per day. No latex paint, no propane tanks, no medications.

Keep Northern Illinois Beautiful (KNIB)

Three Rockford-area recycling centers · 815-637-1343 · knib.org

Electronics recycling. TVs and monitors carry a published fee; most other covered devices are free.

Computers, printers, and household electronics. Call for center locations, hours, and current TV fees.

ShredTronics

4231 E State St, Rockford

TV & electronics drop-off.

Local e-waste recycler for televisions and monitors. Call ahead for hours and fees.

Rock River Valley Composting

6200 Baxter Rd, Cherry Valley · 815-874-5870

$50/ton, 1-ton minimum · credit/debit only.

Yard waste, brush, and leaves. The Winnebago Landfill takes NO yard waste — this is the place for it.

4 LANDFILLS & TRANSFER STATIONS (DIY HAULING)

Winnebago Landfill — closest

8630 Lindenwood Rd, Rockford · 815-874-4806

$70/ton, $110 minimum. Mon–Fri 7 AM–4:30 PM, Sat 7 AM–12 PM (verify Saturday).

Household trash and construction debris. NO yard waste. The $110 minimum bites on light loads.

Orchard Hills Landfill

8290 Hwy 251 S, Davis Junction · 815-874-9000

$60/ton + taxes & fees. Mon–Fri, call for hours.

About 12 miles out — often the cheapest everyday option once Winnebago's minimum is factored in.

Rochelle Municipal Landfill #2

6513 Mulford Rd, Rochelle · 815-384-4251

$50/ton, $100 minimum. Brush $40/ton, leaves/grass $30/ton.

Best for heavy loads: anything up to 2 tons is $100 flat. Wasteful for light loads.

Freeport Transfer Station

2133 S Walnut Rd, Freeport · 815-233-0742

$65/ton, $35 minimum per 1,000 lbs.

Takes landscape waste and recyclables too ($4/bag, no bulk). No electronics.

Rather not haul it yourself?

We haul almost anything — furniture, mattresses, appliances, hot tubs, sheds, construction debris, estate cleanouts. You point, we lift, we sweep up after. **Small loads start at $90, a full 10×6 trailer load is $425 flat,** and your exact price is confirmed from a photo before we start. Usually same-day.

Call or text (779) 772-1857

firststepjunk.com · Open daily 7:30 AM–7:30 PM · Rockford, Rockton, Roscoe, Belvidere, Loves Park, Machesney Park & nearby

Scan for a free quote

Information verified November 2026 from the City of Rockford, Rock River Disposal, the Illinois EPA, and facility listings. Rules and fees change — call ahead. FirstStep Junk Removal cannot haul hazardous waste, wet paint, fuel, or chemicals.